

A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR BUSY WOMEN

The Switch-Off Sequence

Why trying harder to relax can keep an overactive mind stuck on -
and the three-step process that helps you break the loop.

By Faith Poirier, Certified Clinical Hypnotherapist



The Mistake Is Trying to Outthink Overthinking

If overthinking were a choice, you would have stopped choosing it a long time ago.

You already know replaying the conversation will not change what happened. You know rewriting tomorrow's list for the fourth time will not make tomorrow easier. You know your body needs sleep.

But when the room gets quiet, your mind starts another shift. It searches for what you forgot, prepares for what might go wrong, and revisits what you should have said.

Understanding a pattern is not the same as changing it.

Somewhere along the way, staying alert may have become connected to being prepared, responsible, productive, or safe. That is why more information does not always solve the problem.

You do not need to win an argument with every thought. You need to change the loop that keeps switching the mental noise back on.

Three Loops That Keep a Busy Mind Working

1. Unfinished Mental Tabs

Tasks, reminders, conversations, and worries keep floating back because your mind does not trust that they have been safely captured. They are not all urgent. They simply have nowhere else to go.

2. The Responsible Mind on Patrol

Your mind scans schedules, relationships, work, and possible outcomes because it has learned that vigilance prevents mistakes. You may look capable on the outside while feeling mentally exhausted inside.

3. The Relaxation Performance Test

The more desperately you need sleep, the more relaxation becomes another job to get right. You check whether you feel calm yet, count the hours remaining, and judge yourself for still thinking.

Every check tells your mind there is a problem that deserves more attention.

The Three-Step Switch-Off Sequence

Move beyond talking about the pattern and begin practicing a different response.

1

Uncover the Loop

Identify the thought, trigger, belief, or habit that keeps repeating. Get specific about what switches your mind on, what your mind believes it is accomplishing, and what you want to happen instead.

2

Repattern the Response

In a calm, focused state, use targeted hypnotherapy, guided imagery, reframing, and suggestion to help your mind rehearse a different response. You are giving your mind another pattern to follow.

3

Reinforce the Calm

Bring the work back into daily life. Know what to notice, what to practice, and which simple tools to use when the old loop tries to restart.

Uncover the loop. Repattern the response. Reinforce the calm.

You Are Awake, Aware, and in Control

Hypnosis does not mean losing control. You can hear Faith, speak, move, ask to pause, or stop at any time.

Nothing is done to you. You agree on the goal first, and the process is collaborative from beginning to end. Sessions are virtual, so you can do the work from your own quiet, comfortable space.

What May Change When the Loop Changes?

- Your mind does not need to follow every thought to the end.
- Bedtime feels less like another round of planning and problem-solving.
- Old beliefs become easier to recognize instead of automatically treating them as facts.
- Stressful moments create less reactivity and less internal noise.
- You have practical ways to return to calm without adding another complicated routine.

"Before working with Faith, I could not get to bed before 2:00 a.m. most nights - my mind would not shut off. After our sessions, I started getting to sleep around 11:00 p.m. I felt calmer at night and had practical tools I could use when my mind started racing."

- Andi

Individual experiences vary. No ethical practitioner can promise the same result for every person.

YOUR NEXT STEP

If Your Mind Never Seems to Clock Out, Start Here

You do not need to commit to a package or decide whether hypnotherapy is right for you today.

Start with a free, confidential 15-minute call. Tell Faith what is happening in your own words, ask anything you want to know about hypnosis or virtual sessions, and get an honest answer about whether this approach makes sense for what you are facing.

There is no pressure and no obligation.

[Book your free 15-minute call](#)

Faith Poirier is a Certified Clinical Hypnotherapist, a graduate of the nationally accredited Hypnosis Motivation Institute with more than 1,200 hours of training, and a professional member of the American Hypnosis Association.

Hypnotherapy is a complementary wellness modality and is not a substitute for medical, psychological, or psychiatric care. No claims of diagnosis or cure are made. Always consult your healthcare provider for medical or mental health concerns.